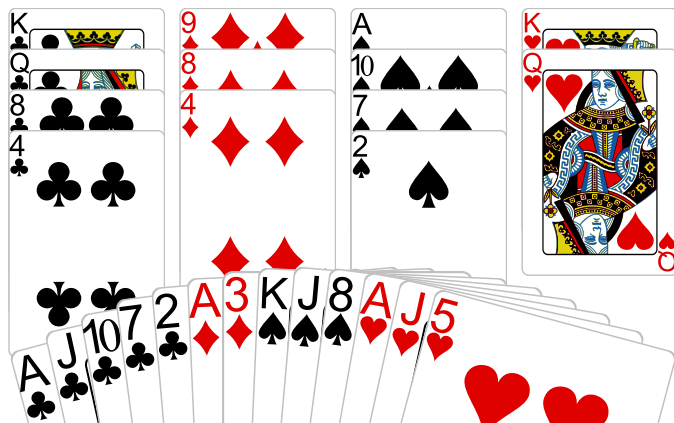
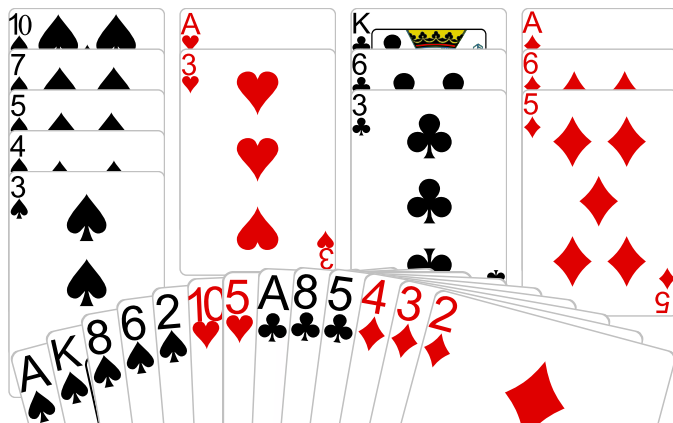


**Deal 1** Ctr: 6♣ Goal: at most \_\_\_\_ losers



| Count Fast and Slow Losers  |         |       |        |       |
|-----------------------------|---------|-------|--------|-------|
| ♠                           | ♥       | ♦     | ♣      | Total |
|                             |         |       |        |       |
| Decide How to Reduce Losers |         |       |        |       |
| Ruffs                       | Finesse | Pitch | Length |       |
|                             |         |       |        |       |

**Deal 3** Ctr: 4♠ Goal: at most \_\_\_\_ losers



| Count Fast and Slow Losers  |         |       |        |       |
|-----------------------------|---------|-------|--------|-------|
| ♠                           | ♥       | ♦     | ♣      | Total |
|                             |         |       |        |       |
| Decide How to Reduce Losers |         |       |        |       |
| Ruffs                       | Finesse | Pitch | Length |       |
|                             |         |       |        |       |

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♣

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Board: 5

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6♠

Declarer: South

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 4 3  
 ♥ 10 7 6 2  
 ♦ J 7 6  
 ♣ 9 5 3

♠ K J 8

♥ A J 5

♦ A 3

♣ A J 10 7 2



♠ 9 6 5

♥ 9 8 4 3

♦ K Q 10 5 2

♣ 6

♠ A 10 7 2

♥ K Q

♦ 9 8 4

♣ K Q 8 4

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          | 1♣    | Pass | 1♠    |
| Pass     | 2NT   | Pass | 4♣    |
| Pass     | 6♣    |      |       |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

6♣ by North  
a ♠ loser from your hand.

The slam was easy to bid, now you just have to make it. North plays 6♣. East leads the ♦Q.

You have one certain ♦ loser, and a two-way finesse for the ♠Q. That should make you start thinking about elimination and throw-in. So win the ♦A and pull trumps, East having a singleton.

Now eliminate ♥s from your hand and dummy by playing ♥K, ♥A, ♥J. **BUT BE CAREFUL!** On the ♥J you must discard a ♦ from dummy so both of you will be out of ♦s at the throw-in.

**NOW** you can execute the throw-in. Play your ♦, which eliminates ♦s from both you and dummy and at the same time throws in one of the defenders. Whoever it is will be forced to lead a ♠ and eliminate your guess for the ♠Q or else give you a ruff-sluff, allowing you to ruff in dummy and discard

Among Bridge players you often hear about someone (usually Aunt Harriet) who is amazingly lucky at guessing the location of missing Queens.

Perhaps Aunt Harriet isn't that lucky after all, perhaps she just knows how to perform elimination plays.

Hopefully in the future you will be the one with the reputation!

**Board 3**

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 7 5 4 3

♥ A 3

♦ A 6 5

♣ K 6 3

♠ -

♥ 9 6

♦ K Q J 10 8 7

♣ Q J 9 7 2



♠ A K 8 6 2

♥ 10 5

♦ 4 3 2

♣ A 8 5

♠ Q J 9

♥ K Q J 8 7 4 2

♦ 9

♣ 10 4

West

North

East

South

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

1 ♠

4 ♥

Play your ♠ A, the ♦ A and the ♣ A K. South follows to everything.

You've done all you can do. Now play the ♥ 10 to South's high ♥.

South has just won his side's first trick with the ♥ J. He now plays the ♠ Q, winning his side's second trick.

Now, South is still on lead, and he has nothing in his hand but good ♥s. So he leads one of them, and you **DO NOT RUFF**. Instead you discard a ♣ from dummy and a ♦ from your own hand. South has now taken his side's third trick. He plays another good ♥, and you ruff in dummy and discard the last ♦ loser from your hand. You can now cross-ruff for the rest of the tricks.

Incredible isn't it.

You just wonder how many bridge players would have just conceded down 2 on this hand.

Not you or me, of course.

When the bidding gets high in a hurry you sometimes have to guess what you can make. East plays 4 ♠. South leads the ♥ K.

And it looks like you are too high. Assuming the trumps split 2-1, you still have one ♥ loser, two ♦ losers and one ♣ loser.

You win the ♥ A and play a ♠ to your ♠ K. North discards a ♦!

From bad to worse. Now you must add a ♠ loser to the four you already had. Are you finished?

No, never give up. South has a bunch of ♥s and 3 ♠s, so he cannot have many ♦s and ♣s. If you can eliminate those and then throw him in it should work to your advantage.

**Board 5**

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 6  
♥ K 8 2  
♦ K Q 10 3 2  
♣ 10 8 6 4

♠ A 10 9 3  
♥ 7 5 4  
♦ A J 6  
♣ Q 7 5



♠ 8 5  
♥ J 10 9 6  
♦ 9 8 7 4  
♣ J 9 2

♠ K Q J 7 4 2  
♥ A Q 3  
♦ 5  
♣ A K 3

| <i>West</i>  | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|--------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
|              |              | Pass        | 1 ♠          |
| Pass         | 3 ♠          | Pass        | 4NT          |
| Pass         | 5 ♥          | Pass        | 6 ♠          |
| All Pass     |              |             |              |
| 6 ♠ by South |              |             |              |